

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Legal Operations and Compliance English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For legal operations staff, compliance managers, contract managers, policy owners, audit teams, investigation coordinators, privacy operations staff, and risk professionals.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Contract Intake and Workflow

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Policy Implementation and Controls

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Compliance Audits and Evidence

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Internal Investigations

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Privacy Operations and Data Requests

Clarify missing information before responding.

06 Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

07 Training, Attestations, and Culture

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

08 Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Contract Intake and Workflow

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A contract intake request says "urgent" but omits the agreement type, business owner, and required decision date.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

contract intake - Collecting and routing the information needed to begin contract-related work.

template - A reusable document or structure used as a starting point for consistent work.

approval path - The sequence of people or steps needed to authorize a decision.

triage - Sorting issues by urgency, severity, risk, owner, and next action.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Urgent does not identify the decision

The lesson's contract intake says urgent but omits agreement type, business owner, and required decision date; this is fictional workflow practice, not legal advice.

01 • Legal operations coordinator: The contract intake says urgent. Could you clarify the agreement type before we identify the appropriate approval path?

02 • Business requester: I haven't included that or the business owner. I can see the request isn't ready for useful triage.

03 • Legal operations coordinator: Thank you. We also need the required decision date and why that timing matters.

04 • Business requester: Could you simply prioritize it first while I gather the missing information?

05 • Legal operations coordinator: We need enough context to assess priority through the actual intake process, rather than infer it from urgent.

06 • Business requester: Understood. Should I choose any familiar template to make the request more complete?

07 • Legal operations coordinator: Don't guess the template. First clarify the agreement and business need so the responsible team can route it.

08 • Business requester: I'll confirm the owner and required decision date, distinguishing a target from an external commitment.

09 • Legal operations coordinator: Good. Mark anything still unknown instead of filling the gaps with assumptions.

10 • Business requester: I'll return the clarified intake so the team can assess the request and its priority accurately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A renewal or a new agreement?

Separate fictional case: a requester labels a vendor document renewal, but the intake does not identify the existing agreement or whether the proposed scope changed.

01 • Contract intake analyst: You labeled this a renewal. Could you identify the existing agreement and whether the proposed services have changed?

02 • Business owner: I haven't linked the existing agreement, and I need to check the scope against the new document.

03 • Contract intake analyst: Then we shouldn't route it solely on the assumption that it repeats the prior arrangement.

04 • Business owner: Would the same vendor name be enough to select the previous approval path?

05 • Contract intake analyst: Not by itself. The document type and changed scope may affect the appropriate triage questions.

06 • Business owner: I'll provide the existing agreement reference and identify the differences I can confirm.

07 • Contract intake analyst: Thank you. Please distinguish confirmed changes from points you want the reviewer to interpret.

08 • Business owner: Understood. I won't describe the new terms as approved just because we have used the vendor before.

09 • Contract intake analyst: Good. Once the context is clear, the responsible team can determine the applicable workflow.

10 • Business owner: I'll complete those details and keep the renewal label provisional until the document relationship is understood.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A signature deadline or a requested review date?

Separate fictional case: an intake form lists Friday without explaining whether it is a signature deadline, a meeting date, or a preferred review date.

01 • Legal intake specialist: The date field says Friday. Could you clarify what needs to happen by then?

02 • Commercial project lead: I meant our preferred review date, but the form doesn't explain that. It is not a confirmed signature deadline.

03 • Legal intake specialist: That distinction matters for triage. We should record the requested decision and timing accurately.

04 • Commercial project lead: Could you guarantee completion on Friday now that the date is only our preference?

05 • Legal intake specialist: No. The responsible team still needs to assess the request, scope, and capacity before confirming timing.

06 • Commercial project lead: I'll explain the meeting purpose and identify which business question we need help resolving.

07 • Legal intake specialist: Please also confirm the business owner and intended document version so the approval path isn't based on assumptions.

08 • Commercial project lead: Understood. I can supply those details without presenting the review request as a request to sign.

09 • Legal intake specialist: Good. We'll preserve Friday as your requested review date and await the team's actual response.

10 • Commercial project lead: I'll communicate that internally so nobody treats an intake date as a confirmed legal commitment.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Contract Intake and Workflow

A contract intake request says "urgent" but omits the agreement type, business owner, and required decision date.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could you confirm the agreement type, business owner, and reason for the requested date? That will help the team route and prioritize the request using the actual business need.

Scenario 2 | An attachment with no counterparty identified

A fictional contract request contains a blank template and the label urgent, but no counterparty name or business owner. No external deadline is supplied. Hold an intake clarification conversation rather than choosing an approval route by guesswork.

Role A: You are the intake coordinator. Ask for agreement purpose, counterparty, business owner, and the meaning of urgent.

Role B: You are the project requester. Identify the gaps and explain whom you must consult.

Possible opening: Could you clarify the agreement's purpose and counterparty before we determine how to route this template?

Success checks

- Clarify required identities and purpose specifically.
- Do not invent an owner, deadline, or approval path.
- Agree who will supply the missing intake context.

Add a complication: The requester wants to reuse another team's owner name because it makes the form look complete.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Policy Implementation and Controls

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A policy has been published, but nobody has identified who performs the related check or keeps the evidence.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

policy - Formal rule or standard that guides decisions and behavior.

control - A process, approval, check, or technical safeguard designed to reduce risk.

monitoring - Repeatedly observing information to track conditions or detect changes.

process owner - The person accountable for how a defined process operates and improves.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - B. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - C. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - B. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - C. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A published policy is not an operating control

The lesson's policy is published, but the person performing the check and the person retaining evidence have not been identified.

01 • Compliance operations lead: The policy is published, but who performs the related check and who keeps its evidence remain unassigned.

02 • Business process manager: Isn't publishing the policy itself the control, since staff can now read what is expected?

03 • Compliance operations lead: A policy states an expectation. A control is an action or arrangement intended to help meet that expectation.

04 • Business process manager: Then publication doesn't establish that the related check actually happens or leaves evidence.

05 • Compliance operations lead: Correct. We need the process owner to define the action, responsibility, and appropriate record under our approved process.

06 • Business process manager: How does monitoring differ from performing the check in the first place?

07 • Compliance operations lead: Monitoring examines how the arrangement is operating; it doesn't substitute for an unassigned control action.

08 • Business process manager: I'll explain the distinction to the implementation team and identify the open ownership questions.

09 • Compliance operations lead: Good. Avoid describing the policy as implemented solely because the document is available.

10 • Business process manager: We'll confirm the control responsibilities and evidence arrangements before claiming that the operational change is complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A reminder is not evidence of a completed check

Separate fictional case: an approved internal process sends a reminder for a monthly access review; the reminder was sent, but no review result is recorded.

01 • Control coordinator: The monthly access-review reminder was sent, but no result from the review has been recorded.

02 • Process owner: Our tracker counted the reminder as completion. What distinction should we explain to the team?

03 • Control coordinator: The reminder prompts the action. Evidence of the review shows whether the required check was actually performed.

04 • Process owner: So an automated message isn't proof that someone assessed the access list or addressed any finding.

05 • Control coordinator: Exactly. The control record needs to reflect the actual action under this approved internal process.

06 • Process owner: Could monitoring the reminder delivery still be useful, even though it doesn't establish review completion?

07 • Control coordinator: Yes. It answers a narrower question about notification, not the effectiveness or performance of the access review.

08 • Process owner: I'll distinguish notification status from review status and ask the responsible reviewer for the actual result.

09 • Control coordinator: Good. Keep the missing evidence visible rather than treating the message timestamp as a completed control.

10 • Process owner: I'll update our explanation and confirm what work happened before changing the review's status.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A control design differs from an operating result

Separate fictional case: a team has approved a design for checking supplier bank-detail changes, but has not tested or implemented it; no real transaction instructions are discussed.

01 • Policy implementation lead: The design for the supplier-change check is approved, but it hasn't been implemented or tested.

02 • Process owner: Can we describe that as an effective control, or only as an approved design?

03 • Policy implementation lead: Only the design approval is established. Operating effectiveness concerns what happens when the control actually runs.

04 • Process owner: Then the policy expectation, control design, and operating evidence are three different layers of information.

05 • Policy implementation lead: Yes. We should explain them separately so approval of the plan isn't mistaken for proof of performance.

06 • Process owner: Would training attendance establish that the control is working once we introduce it?

07 • Policy implementation lead: Attendance shows participation in training, not successful operation. The actual process needs appropriate evidence and monitoring.

08 • Process owner: I'll keep implementation and testing pending in the status report and identify the responsible owners.

09 • Policy implementation lead: Good. We can discuss readiness without prescribing transaction steps or inventing an assurance finding.

10 • Process owner: I'll confirm the next implementation actions under our approved process before presenting any operating conclusion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Policy Implementation and Controls

A policy has been published, but nobody has identified who performs the related check or keeps the evidence.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Publishing the policy is one step. We also need to identify who performs the check, how often, and where its evidence is recorded so the process can operate consistently.

Scenario 2 | An exception log with no review owner

A fictional team records policy exceptions in a log, but nobody is assigned to review the entries. Logging is active; review and follow-up are unconfirmed. Explain how recording differs from monitoring and resolution.

Role A: You are the compliance coordinator. Explain what the log demonstrates and what it does not.

Role B: You are the process manager. Ask which ownership questions must be resolved before claiming the process operates fully.

Possible opening: The log records exceptions, but it doesn't establish that anyone reviews or acts on them.

Success checks

- Distinguish recording, review, and follow-up.
- Avoid asserting effectiveness without operating evidence.
- Agree who will clarify review ownership and evidence requirements.

Add a complication: A colleague says an automated log means the control is fully effective.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Compliance Audits and Evidence

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

An auditor requests records for a specific period. A team proposes sending a current screenshot with no date context.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

audit - A systematic examination of evidence against defined requirements or criteria.

evidence - Information that supports or challenges a claim or conclusion.

retention - Keeping customers, users, staff, or records over a stated period; specify which meaning applies.

sample - A selected part of a population or material used for examination or analysis.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - B. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
 - C. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - B. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?
 - C. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Current screenshots cannot document an unspecified past state

The lesson's auditor requests records for a specific period; the team proposes a current screenshot with no date context.

01 • Audit coordinator: Could you provide records for the requested period rather than only a current screenshot without date context?

02 • Control owner: The screenshot shows today's configuration. Would that satisfy evidence of how the control operated during the audit period?

03 • Audit coordinator: It doesn't establish the historical state by itself. Please identify dated records relevant to the actual request.

04 • Control owner: I'll check what evidence is retained and tell you if records from that period are unavailable.

05 • Audit coordinator: Thank you. Please include the source and period so the auditor can assess the material in context.

06 • Control owner: Should I recreate an old-looking screenshot if the original record cannot be found?

07 • Audit coordinator: No. Don't manufacture historical evidence. Report the gap and ask the audit owner how it should be handled.

08 • Control owner: Understood. I'll distinguish current information from historical records and explain any retention limitation I find.

09 • Audit coordinator: Please confirm availability and realistic preparation timing once you've checked the source records.

10 • Control owner: I'll return with the relevant evidence or a clear gap report, not an unsupported substitute.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A sample request needs identifiable records

Separate fictional case: an auditor requests the approvals for sample items A17 and A23; the process owner sends an undifferentiated folder of approvals.

01 • Audit liaison: Could you identify the approval records corresponding to sample items A17 and A23 in this folder?

02 • Process owner: I sent the full folder, but I haven't mapped those two sample references to their records.

03 • Audit liaison: Please provide that mapping so the reviewer can assess the requested evidence without guessing which files belong.

04 • Process owner: Would it be easier to select two approvals with similar dates if the references aren't obvious?

05 • Audit liaison: No. Similar dates don't establish a match. Keep any unresolved reference question visible.

06 • Process owner: I'll check the underlying record identifiers and ask the system owner about any missing link.

07 • Audit liaison: Thank you. Use the approved evidence channel and avoid including unrelated sensitive material merely to make the package larger.

08 • Process owner: Understood. More files aren't necessarily better evidence when their relationship to the sample is unclear.

09 • Audit liaison: Please advise when you can confirm the mapping and flag any record that cannot be located.

10 • Process owner: I'll return a traceable response for the two sample items, with any remaining gap stated explicitly.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A redacted record needs an explained limit

Separate fictional case: an audit evidence package contains redacted approval records; the reviewer cannot see approval dates, and disclosure permissions have not been reassessed.

01 • Audit evidence coordinator: The approval dates are hidden in this package. Could you check whether a reviewed version can support this audit request?

02 • Records owner: I'll consult the responsible reviewer. I shouldn't remove redactions on my own to make the files easier to assess.

03 • Audit evidence coordinator: Exactly. We need useful evidence within the authorized disclosure arrangements, not an improvised release of information.

04 • Records owner: Should I explain which relevant fields are unavailable in the current version while that check is pending?

05 • Audit evidence coordinator: Yes. That helps distinguish a record limitation from a conclusion about whether an approval occurred.

06 • Records owner: I can request guidance on the dates and ask what alternative evidence may be appropriate.

07 • Audit evidence coordinator: Please include the audit period and sample references so the review question is precise.

08 • Records owner: Understood. I won't claim the redacted records prove timely approval when the dates cannot be examined.

09 • Audit evidence coordinator: Confirm response timing after the permission and evidence options are assessed.

10 • Records owner: I'll report the approved route and remaining limitations before we describe the package as complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Compliance Audits and Evidence

An auditor requests records for a specific period. A team proposes sending a current screenshot with no date context.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could we provide evidence covering the requested period and identify its source? A current screenshot alone may not answer the historical question in the request.

Scenario 2 | A missing timestamp in an exported audit log

A fictional audit-log export omits timestamps because the selected export view excluded that column. The underlying timestamps may exist but have not been checked. Request a corrected or clarified export without assuming the source is complete.

Role A: You are the audit coordinator. Ask for the requested period, timestamps, and source context.

Role B: You are the system owner. Confirm the export-view limitation and check underlying availability before promising a replacement.

Possible opening: Could you check whether the underlying log contains timestamps and provide a period-specific export if available?

Success checks

- Distinguish an export omission from a confirmed source-data absence.
- Reject invented historical dates and request actual evidence.
- Agree the availability check and response timing.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests typing approximate dates into the exported rows.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Internal Investigations

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A hotline report contains an allegation and the reporter's interpretation. The intake note presents both as established facts.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

hotline - A designated channel for raising concerns or seeking assistance.

non-retaliation - Requirement that people are not punished or disadvantaged for making a good-faith report, complaint, or participation in an investigation.

confidentiality - Protecting information from disclosure to people who are not authorized to receive it.

evidence - Information that supports or challenges a claim or conclusion.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An allegation and an interpretation are not findings

The lesson's hotline intake presents the reporter's allegation and interpretation as established facts; no investigative conclusion is supplied.

01 • Investigation intake coordinator: The hotline note treats the allegation and the reporter's interpretation as confirmed facts. That wording needs correction.

02 • Case review lead: What should it say without minimizing the concern or deciding whether the report is true?

03 • Investigation intake coordinator: Attribute the allegation to the report and distinguish the reporter's interpretation from independently established evidence.

04 • Case review lead: So accurate qualification doesn't mean dismissing the report; it preserves what we actually know at intake.

05 • Investigation intake coordinator: Exactly. The concern still goes through the established process, with confidentiality handled according to the applicable arrangements.

06 • Case review lead: Should we promise that no details will ever be shared beyond the two of us?

07 • Investigation intake coordinator: No. Use the approved confidentiality explanation rather than an absolute promise we cannot substantiate.

08 • Case review lead: I'll also refer any non-retaliation question through the organization's established guidance, without inventing a policy statement.

09 • Investigation intake coordinator: Good. Keep the original account traceable and avoid adding a motive or conclusion that hasn't been established.

10 • Case review lead: I'll correct the intake wording and preserve the distinction between report, interpretation, and verified finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A missing document is not proof of deliberate concealment

Separate fictional case: an internal review cannot locate a referenced approval email; no evidence explains why it is missing.

01 • Case analyst: We haven't located the approval email. The draft says the manager deliberately concealed it.

02 • Investigation lead: That motive is not established. A missing record doesn't by itself prove deliberate concealment.

03 • Case analyst: Then the verified statement is that our search has not located the referenced email so far.

04 • Investigation lead: Correct, with the search scope identified. We also shouldn't claim the email never existed.

05 • Case analyst: Could we list possible explanations without presenting one as the conclusion of the investigation?

06 • Investigation lead: Use the review process to identify relevant next questions. Avoid speculative accusations in the case summary.

07 • Case analyst: I'll distinguish the evidence gap from any allegation about why the record is unavailable.

08 • Investigation lead: Good. Keep sensitive case information within the authorized review channel and preserve the relevant source records.

09 • Case analyst: I'll revise the wording and identify which additional record check the assigned reviewer needs to consider.

10 • Investigation lead: That makes the summary useful without turning absence of evidence into a finding about intent.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Two accounts agree on an event, not its motive

Separate fictional case: two internal interview accounts say a meeting was cancelled; only one account attributes the cancellation to retaliation, and no finding has been made.

01 • Investigation analyst: Both interview accounts say the meeting was cancelled, but only one attributes it to retaliation.

02 • Review counsel: Then don't describe two corroborating accounts of retaliation. Their overlap concerns the cancellation itself.

03 • Investigation analyst: Understood. Agreement on an event doesn't establish agreement on its cause or motive.

04 • Review counsel: Correct. The summary should attribute the interpretation and leave the allegation for the appropriate assessment.

05 • Investigation analyst: Could we still treat the retaliation concern seriously while avoiding a premature conclusion?

06 • Review counsel: Yes. Careful qualification and appropriate handling do not minimize the concern or decide its validity.

07 • Investigation analyst: I'll keep the two accounts distinct and avoid merging their wording into a stronger claim.

08 • Review counsel: Good. Use the established confidentiality and non-retaliation guidance for any process communication, not an invented assurance.

09 • Investigation analyst: I'll revise the evidence summary to identify the shared observation and the separately reported interpretation.

10 • Review counsel: Then we can review the actual evidential position without overstating what the two accounts support.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Internal Investigations

A hotline report contains an allegation and the reporter's interpretation. The intake note presents both as established facts.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: I'll distinguish the reported event from the reporter's interpretation and use neutral wording. The investigation process should establish findings; the intake note should not prejudge them.

Scenario 2 | An anonymous report with a named document

A fictional anonymous hotline report alleges that a training record was altered and names a specific file. The file has not been reviewed. Discuss the intake summary and appropriate routing without deciding whether alteration occurred.

Role A: You are the intake coordinator. Attribute the allegation and identify the unreviewed document reference.

Role B: You are the investigation lead. Ask what is known and what needs authorized review.

Possible opening: The report alleges an alteration and identifies a file, but we have not examined that file or established what happened.

Success checks

- Separate report content from verified evidence.
- Avoid inferring truth or falsity from anonymity alone.
- Agree restricted routing and the next authorized evidence review.

Add a complication: A colleague treats anonymity as proof that the allegation is false.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Privacy Operations and Data Requests

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A data request arrives with insufficient information to identify the requester or scope. Staff are unsure which workflow applies.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

data subject request - Request from an individual to access, correct, delete, restrict, or otherwise exercise rights over personal data.

personal data - Information relating to an identified or identifiable person under the relevant legal definition.

verification - Checking whether specified requirements have been met.

exception - An item that differs from an expected rule or normal processing path.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Clarify the request before selecting the workflow

The lesson's data request lacks sufficient requester identity and scope; the applicable workflow remains unclear.

01 • Privacy operations coordinator: This request doesn't establish the requester's identity or the scope. Could we clarify those before choosing a workflow?

02 • Service intake lead: The message says send my data, but I don't know which service or information they mean.

03 • Privacy operations coordinator: Then we should use the approved clarification and verification process, not guess the intended personal data.

04 • Service intake lead: Should I ask for every identity document I can think of to make verification more certain?

05 • Privacy operations coordinator: No. Follow the applicable process and request only what it requires; don't improvise additional sensitive-data collection.

06 • Service intake lead: Understood. I also shouldn't promise that this is a completed data subject request when intake details remain unresolved.

07 • Privacy operations coordinator: Correct. Nor should we decide an exception applies before the authorized team assesses the actual request.

08 • Service intake lead: Could you identify which current procedure we should consult and who can clarify its applicability?

09 • Privacy operations coordinator: I'll route that question to the responsible privacy owner and confirm the approved next communication.

10 • Service intake lead: I'll keep scope and verification pending, without inventing a deadline or an outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A company contact requesting another person's data

Separate fictional case: a business customer contact requests records about a former employee; the requester's authority, purpose, and applicable process are unverified.

01 • Privacy intake analyst: The business contact requests a former employee's records. What authority and purpose have been established for that request?

02 • Account support lead: None yet. I recognized the company name, but that doesn't confirm authority over another person's data.

03 • Privacy intake analyst: Exactly. We need the approved clarification and verification route before disclosing or categorizing the requested records.

04 • Account support lead: Could I use their active customer account as sufficient verification of the full request?

05 • Privacy intake analyst: An account relationship doesn't answer every authority or scope question. Don't extend it by assumption.

06 • Account support lead: I'll avoid sending personal data and ask the privacy owner which clarification is appropriate.

07 • Privacy intake analyst: Good. Keep the distinction between requester identity and authority to receive particular information.

08 • Account support lead: And we shouldn't automatically label it a data subject request simply because it mentions an individual.

09 • Privacy intake analyst: Correct. The responsible team needs to determine the applicable workflow from the actual circumstances.

10 • Account support lead: I'll route the specific questions and preserve the unresolved status until the authorized guidance arrives.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Delete my account or answer a privacy request?

Separate fictional case: a service user writes delete my account and everything; the intended scope and applicable deletion or privacy workflow have not been established.

01 • Service operations agent: The user says delete my account and everything. Could you clarify which process should handle that wording?

02 • Privacy operations specialist: We first need the approved scope clarification. Account closure and a request concerning personal data may involve different questions.

03 • Service operations agent: So I shouldn't assume closing access resolves every part of what the user requested.

04 • Privacy operations specialist: Correct. Nor should you promise that all records will be deleted without an authorized assessment.

05 • Service operations agent: Could I ask what they mean by everything using our approved response, rather than list invented exceptions?

06 • Privacy operations specialist: Yes. Follow the applicable verification and clarification process, and avoid collecting information that isn't required.

07 • Service operations agent: I'll preserve the original wording so the receiving team can see the request rather than only my interpretation.

08 • Privacy operations specialist: Good. Keep any retention or exception question for the responsible reviewer; don't announce a legal conclusion.

09 • Service operations agent: I'll route the clarified request and describe account closure separately from the broader privacy question.

10 • Privacy operations specialist: That gives the team a clearer basis for choosing the appropriate workflow and response.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Privacy Operations and Data Requests

A data request arrives with insufficient information to identify the requester or scope. Staff are unsure which workflow applies.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could we confirm the request type and required verification through the privacy process? Let's identify the relevant information without assuming access or disclosure is already authorized.

Scenario 2 | A date range missing from a records request

A fictional requester asks for personal data related to support interactions but does not identify the relevant service or whether they intend all interactions. Identity verification status is also unknown. Discuss approved clarification without narrowing the request by assumption.

Role A: You are the privacy coordinator. Ask which service and intended scope need clarification through the established process.

Role B: You are the support intake lead. Preserve the original request and seek verification status from the authorized owner.

Possible opening: We need to clarify the service and intended scope without assuming the requester wants only recent interactions.

Success checks

- Avoid substituting a convenient scope for the requester's intent.
- Keep verification status explicit and use the approved process.
- Agree the responsible owner and precise clarification questions.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests selecting the last month because that is easiest to export.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

Two vendors offer similar services. One handles more personal data and relies on additional subcontractors.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

third-party risk - Risk arising from relationships with outside providers or partners.

due diligence - Structured review of facts, risks, obligations, and evidence before a transaction, onboarding, investment, or decision.

data processing - Operations performed on data, such as collection, storage, transformation, or analysis.

vendor questionnaire - A structured request for information used to evaluate a supplier's capabilities or risks.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.
 - B. An increase of seven percentage points.
 - C. An increase of one percentage point.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Similar services, different data-processing scope

The lesson's vendors provide similar services, but one processes more personal data and uses additional subcontractors.

01 • Procurement risk lead: The vendors offer similar services, but one handles more personal data and relies on additional subcontractors.

02 • Business sponsor: Can we treat their third-party risk as equivalent because the service descriptions look alike?

03 • Procurement risk lead: No. The data-processing scope and subcontractor arrangements need comparison alongside the business functionality.

04 • Business sponsor: Does handling more data automatically make that vendor unacceptable, or is further due diligence needed?

05 • Procurement risk lead: Further assessment is needed. We shouldn't convert a scope difference into an automatic risk decision.

06 • Business sponsor: Then compare both vendors against the same criteria and make the differences and unknowns visible.

07 • Procurement risk lead: Agreed. The vendor questionnaire can support the review, but responses need appropriate evidence and assessment.

08 • Business sponsor: I want the decision to reflect the tradeoff, including any operational benefit of the broader processing.

09 • Procurement risk lead: We'll identify that benefit only where supported, and keep approval with the authorized reviewers.

10 • Business sponsor: Good. Bring a consistent comparison rather than a recommendation based solely on price or the questionnaire's completion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A completed questionnaire versus supporting records

Separate fictional case: vendor A returns a complete questionnaire without attachments; vendor B returns fewer answers with supporting records. Overall assurance has not been assessed.

01 • Vendor risk analyst: A returned every questionnaire answer without attachments; B supplied fewer answers but included supporting records.

02 • Procurement manager: Does the complete questionnaire make A the lower-risk option in our comparison?

03 • Vendor risk analyst: Not automatically. Completion and evidence quality are different criteria, and both vendors still need assessment.

04 • Procurement manager: Then B's attachments don't prove it is stronger overall either, since some answers remain missing.

05 • Vendor risk analyst: Correct. We should compare the same questions, evidence expectations, and unresolved gaps for each vendor.

06 • Procurement manager: Could you distinguish self-reported statements from the supporting material that has actually been reviewed?

07 • Vendor risk analyst: Yes. Due diligence should show the basis for each conclusion rather than count pages or completed fields.

08 • Procurement manager: The tradeoff is a fuller response from A versus more documentation from B, with overall adequacy still open.

09 • Vendor risk analyst: Exactly. I'll request the relevant missing information through the approved process before recommending an assessment outcome.

10 • Procurement manager: I'll keep both statuses pending and avoid labeling questionnaire completion as vendor approval.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A narrow data pilot or the full integration

Separate fictional case: a vendor proposes a narrow pilot using synthetic records or a full integration using customer records; functionality and risk reviews for both are incomplete.

01 • Business project lead: We can explore a synthetic-data pilot or a full integration using customer records. How should we compare them?

02 • Third-party risk reviewer: Use the same business question while distinguishing data-processing scope, functionality tested, and review requirements.

03 • Business project lead: The narrow pilot limits real-data exposure, but it may not test every production requirement.

04 • Third-party risk reviewer: Correct. That is a useful tradeoff, not proof that either option is approved or sufficient.

05 • Business project lead: Could a successful synthetic test establish that the full integration has passed due diligence?

06 • Third-party risk reviewer: No. It would provide evidence within that test scope, leaving the broader processing and operational questions open.

07 • Business project lead: Then the vendor questionnaire should distinguish the proposed pilot from the later integration rather than merge them.

08 • Third-party risk reviewer: Exactly. We need the actual scope and relevant evidence for whichever arrangement is considered.

09 • Business project lead: I'll state the narrower test's limits and ask which approvals are needed before either route proceeds.

10 • Third-party risk reviewer: I'll coordinate that assessment without turning reduced scope into a blanket assurance claim.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

Two vendors offer similar services. One handles more personal data and relies on additional subcontractors.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The service descriptions are similar, but the data handling differs. I'll make those differences visible in the due-diligence summary so the responsible team can assess the relevant risks and controls.

Scenario 2 | A vendor changes its subcontractor list

A fictional vendor's updated questionnaire names two subcontractors, while the earlier review covered one. Their roles and data access are not yet explained. Compare the old and proposed arrangement without assuming the added subcontractor is either harmless or disqualifying.

Role A: You are the vendor risk reviewer. Identify the change and ask for role and data-processing details.

Role B: You are the business owner. Explain the need to compare scope and seek authorized review before drawing a conclusion.

Possible opening: The updated list includes another subcontractor, but its role and access are not yet clear.

Success checks

- Compare the actual earlier and proposed scope.
- Keep the added party's role and risk unassessed rather than assumed.
- Agree a targeted information request and review route.

Add a complication: A colleague says the original vendor approval automatically covers every later arrangement.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Training, Attestations, and Culture

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

Training completion is 98%, but employees still ask how to apply the policy to common situations.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

attestation - A formal confirmation that a statement or requirement has been acknowledged or met.

role-based training - Instruction tailored to the tasks and responsibilities of a particular role.

culture - Shared patterns of behavior and expectations within a group, with variation among individuals.

reinforcement - Follow-up practice, reminders, or support that helps learning or behavior persist.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - B. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
 - C. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - B. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - C. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Completion does not demonstrate application

The lesson's training completion is 98%, but employees still ask how to apply the policy to common situations.

01 • Compliance training lead: Training completion is ninety-eight percent, but employees still ask how the policy applies to common situations.

02 • Business manager: Does that mean the completion figure is wrong, or that it measures something different from practical understanding?

03 • Compliance training lead: It measures completion. Applying the policy requires another kind of evidence, such as appropriate responses to relevant examples.

04 • Business manager: Then an attestation also shouldn't be described as proof that everyone can handle every situation correctly.

05 • Compliance training lead: Exactly. An attestation records what the person confirms under its wording; it doesn't answer every learning question.

06 • Business manager: Would role-based training help connect the general policy to the decisions employees actually face?

07 • Compliance training lead: It may help. We should identify the common questions and provide appropriate reinforcement through the approved guidance.

08 • Business manager: I'll avoid saying the culture is fully embedded because nearly everyone completed a module.

09 • Compliance training lead: Good. Keep participation, understanding, and actual behavior distinct in the training report.

10 • Business manager: We'll use the questions to plan reinforcement and assess practical understanding without discounting the completed training.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Acknowledging receipt is not certifying compliance

Separate fictional case: an internal attestation asks employees to acknowledge receiving a policy; a manager describes it as certification that every requirement has been met.

01 • Learning coordinator: This attestation asks people to acknowledge receiving the policy. It does not ask them to certify every requirement was met.

02 • Department manager: I described it as proof of compliance. That goes beyond the actual wording, then?

03 • Learning coordinator: Yes. Receipt, understanding, and demonstrated compliance are different claims, and this form establishes only the stated acknowledgment.

04 • Department manager: Could you explain that simply for the team without making the acknowledgment sound pointless?

05 • Learning coordinator: It records that the policy reached them. Other processes address questions about understanding and how work is performed.

06 • Department manager: Then we can value the record while keeping its evidential boundary clear.

07 • Learning coordinator: Exactly. Reinforcement can address practical questions, but it should not change the meaning of an existing attestation retrospectively.

08 • Department manager: I'll correct our summary and ask the training owner how to address any common application questions.

09 • Learning coordinator: Good. Use the actual policy and form wording rather than invent a broader assurance statement.

10 • Department manager: I'll distinguish acknowledgment from demonstrated application when I discuss our training status.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A general course and a role-specific decision

Separate fictional case: purchasing staff completed a general conflicts course but ask how to route a supplier-related disclosure; no individual conflict determination is discussed.

01 • Purchasing team manager: Our team completed the general conflicts course, but staff still ask where to route a supplier-related disclosure.

02 • Compliance educator: That suggests a practical application question. Course completion and knowing the role-specific next step are different things.

03 • Purchasing team manager: Should I interpret that question as proof that the training failed completely?

04 • Compliance educator: No. It identifies a reinforcement need, not a comprehensive finding about every part of the course.

05 • Purchasing team manager: Could we use a fictional purchasing example to explain the approved disclosure route without deciding a real case?

06 • Compliance educator: Yes. Role-based training connects the general expectation to the relevant action within the actual process.

07 • Purchasing team manager: Then we can ask staff to explain the next step, rather than repeat the course title.

08 • Compliance educator: Exactly. That checks understanding of the route, while any substantive conflict assessment remains with the authorized reviewer.

09 • Purchasing team manager: I'll bring the recurring questions and avoid treating an attestation as the answer to them.

10 • Compliance educator: I'll help plan the approved reinforcement and keep its learning purpose separate from a case determination.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Training, Attestations, and Culture

Training completion is 98%, but employees still ask how to apply the policy to common situations.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Completion shows attendance or participation, not necessarily practical understanding. Let's add role-specific scenarios and check whether people can identify the appropriate action in their work.

Scenario 2 | A quiz score mistaken for workplace behavior

A fictional team averaged 90% on a policy quiz. No workplace behavior has been observed, and the quiz's coverage of role-specific situations is unknown. Explain what the result supports and what needs further learning assessment.

Role A: You are the training lead. Distinguish quiz performance from demonstrated workplace application.

Role B: You are the department manager. Ask how role-based examples could clarify the remaining understanding questions.

Possible opening: The quiz score shows performance on those questions, not verified behavior in every workplace situation.

Success checks

- Limit the score claim to the assessed questions.
- Explain understanding and behavior as separate evidence questions.
- Agree a proportionate role-specific reinforcement check without inventing findings.

Add a complication: A manager wants to call the result proof of a fully compliant culture.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A risk committee tracker shows an action as complete because its plan was approved. Implementation evidence is still outstanding.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

governance - Decision structure defining roles, rights, approvals, controls, and accountability.

risk committee - A group responsible for reviewing defined risk matters and related decisions.

risk acceptance - An authorized decision to retain a stated risk under specified conditions.

remediation - Work to correct a problem or reduce its effects; in environmental work, addressing contamination.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team plans to complete the review.
 - B. The team has completed the review.
 - C. The team is completing the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - B. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - C. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Plan approved, implementation evidence outstanding

The lesson's risk committee tracker marks an action complete because its plan was approved; implementation evidence remains outstanding.

01 • Risk committee secretary: The tracker marks remediation complete, but only the plan is approved. Implementation evidence is still outstanding.

02 • Action owner: Then the status should distinguish approval of the approach from completion of the actual work.

03 • Risk committee secretary: Correct. What can we report about implementation without guessing whether the missing evidence means nothing happened?

04 • Action owner: We can state that evidence is outstanding. I need to verify the work status before claiming either completion or nonperformance.

05 • Risk committee secretary: Good. The absence of a record here doesn't itself establish the entire operational history.

06 • Action owner: I'll obtain the relevant implementation status and evidence through our governance process.

07 • Risk committee secretary: Please keep any risk acceptance decision separate; approving a remediation plan doesn't automatically establish acceptance of remaining risk.

08 • Action owner: Understood. I won't infer authority or an acceptance decision from the plan approval.

09 • Risk committee secretary: The committee update will show the approved plan and open verification, with your follow-up responsibility identified.

10 • Action owner: I'll return with the verified status and any remaining gap before we reconsider completion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Implementation complete, effectiveness testing pending

Separate fictional case: a remediation owner reports that a new check is implemented; the planned effectiveness test has not run and the closure criteria have not been reviewed in this conversation.

01 • Remediation owner: The new check has been implemented, but the planned effectiveness test has not yet run.

02 • Governance coordinator: Then we should report those stages separately. Have the actual closure criteria been checked before updating the risk committee tracker?

03 • Remediation owner: Not in this discussion. I'll consult the approved criteria rather than assume implementation alone permits closure.

04 • Governance coordinator: Good. Completed work deserves recognition, while the pending test and closure assessment must remain visible.

05 • Remediation owner: Would saying remediation progressing be enough, or is that too vague for the committee?

06 • Governance coordinator: Be specific: implemented, effectiveness testing pending, closure status subject to the applicable review.

07 • Remediation owner: I'll also identify who owns the test and confirm its timing rather than invent a completion date.

08 • Governance coordinator: Thank you. Keep the action status distinct from any formal risk acceptance or governance decision.

09 • Remediation owner: The update will name the completed implementation and the remaining verification dependency.

10 • Governance coordinator: That gives the committee a clear status without treating a plan, an action, and a tested result as equivalent.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A missing status update is not an accepted risk

Separate fictional case: a committee action has no recent owner update; its risk acceptance field is blank, and no acceptance decision is recorded.

01 • Governance analyst: The action has no recent owner update, and no risk acceptance decision is recorded in the tracker.

02 • Committee coordinator: Could we treat the silence as acceptance of the remaining risk and move the action out of the open list?

03 • Governance analyst: No. Missing communication doesn't establish an authorized decision. We need to confirm the actual status.

04 • Committee coordinator: Then our update should say status confirmation pending, not risk accepted or remediation complete.

05 • Governance analyst: Exactly. We also shouldn't infer that no work happened simply because the latest evidence isn't here.

06 • Committee coordinator: I'll ask the action owner for completed work, outstanding steps, and the supporting record.

07 • Governance analyst: Good. If a risk decision is needed, it must follow the actual governance route and authority.

08 • Committee coordinator: I'll keep that separate from the factual action update rather than create an acceptance entry myself.

09 • Governance analyst: Please bring back the confirmed information and identify any continuing gap for the committee.

10 • Committee coordinator: I will. The tracker will preserve the unresolved status until an evidence-based update or authorized decision is available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

A risk committee tracker shows an action as complete because its plan was approved. Implementation evidence is still outstanding.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The plan is approved; implementation is not yet verified. I'll report those stages separately and identify the evidence needed before the committee treats the action as complete.

Scenario 2 | A deadline extension without a completion decision

A fictional risk committee approved a later target date for an action. Implementation and testing remain incomplete, and no risk acceptance decision is recorded. Give a status update that distinguishes the schedule change from the work and risk decisions.

Role A: You are the action owner. State the approved schedule change and the remaining work.

Role B: You are the committee secretary. Ask how the tracker should preserve incomplete implementation and testing.

Possible opening: The committee approved a later target date, but implementation and testing are still incomplete.

Success checks

- Distinguish the approved date change from completed remediation.
- Avoid inferring risk acceptance from the schedule decision.
- Agree a tracker update with completed and pending stages clearly separated.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to mark the action closed because the committee approved something about it.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Contract Intake and Workflow

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: Could you confirm the agreement type, business owner, and reason for the requested date? That will help the team route and prioritize the request using the actual business need.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Policy Implementation and Controls

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: B - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

B: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

C: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

Check 2: A - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

B: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

C: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

Model response: Publishing the policy is one step. We also need to identify who performs the check, how often, and where its evidence is recorded so the process can operate consistently.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Compliance Audits and Evidence

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: A - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

B: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

C: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

Check 2: C - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

B: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

C: The requested action and information are explicit.

Model response: Could we provide evidence covering the requested period and identify its source? A current screenshot alone may not answer the historical question in the request.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Internal Investigations

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: I'll distinguish the reported event from the reporter's interpretation and use neutral wording. The investigation process should establish findings; the intake note should not prejudge them.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Privacy Operations and Data Requests

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: Could we confirm the request type and required verification through the privacy process? Let's identify the relevant information without assuming access or disclosure is already authorized.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Third-Party Risk and Due Diligence

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: A - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

B: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

C: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

Check 2: C - An increase of one percentage point.

A: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

B: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

C: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

Model response: The service descriptions are similar, but the data handling differs. I'll make those differences visible in the due-diligence summary so the responsible team can assess the relevant risks and controls.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Training, Attestations, and Culture

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

B: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

C: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

Check 2: B - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

B: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

C: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

Model response: Completion shows attendance or participation, not necessarily practical understanding. Let's add role-specific scenarios and check whether people can identify the appropriate action in their work.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Governance, Reporting, and Risk Committees

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: B - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

B: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

C: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

Check 2: A - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

B: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

C: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

Model response: The plan is approved; implementation is not yet verified. I'll report those stages separately and identify the evidence needed before the committee treats the action as complete.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

US Courts: glossary of legal terms

<https://www.uscourts.gov/glossary>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Legal Operations and Compliance English

Professional audience: legal operations staff, compliance managers, contract managers, policy owners, audit teams, investigation coordinators, privacy operations staff, and risk professionals

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Lesson 01: Contract Intake and Workflow

Original fictional case: A contract intake request says "urgent" but omits the agreement type, business owner, and required decision date.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: contract intake: Collecting and routing the information needed to begin contract-related work. / template: A reusable document or structure used as a starting point for consistent work. / approval path: The sequence of people or steps needed to authorize a decision. / triage: Sorting issues by urgency, severity, risk, owner, and next action.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you confirm the agreement type, business owner, and reason for the requested date? That will help the team route and prioritize the request using the actual business need.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level